- Well-designed PBAC policies can balance regulatory requirements and privacy needs, ensuring compliance while minimizing risk.

Regardless of your role—whether as a business leader, security professional, developer, or policymaker—you must consider privacy, confidentiality, and authenticity when designing and using digital systems to interact with employees, partners, and customers.

- Privacy ensures that individuals retain control over what personal or sensitive data is shared, with whom, and under what conditions.
- Confidentiality protects that data from unauthorized access, ensuring it remains secure in storage, transit, and processing.
- Authenticity guarantees that identities, credentials, and transactions are legitimate, preventing impersonation, fraud, data manipulation, or repudiation.

Failing to manage these concerns effectively can lead to data breaches, compliance violations, loss of customer trust, and operational inefficiencies. At the same time, overly restrictive policies can drive up costs, frustrate people, and hinder business agility.

Balancing security, compliance, and usability requires that you understand dynamic authorization. A well-implemented policy-driven authorization model allows you to enforce privacy and confidentiality while maintaining strong authentication and seamless user experiences, all without unnecessary overhead or complexity.

2.8 From identity to authentication

Digital identity plays a foundational role in supporting the relationships on which digital systems rely. Digital identity is not just a technical artifact or a collection of attributes—it is the bridge that connects systems to people, organizations, and devices, enabling those systems to recognize, remember, and relate to them over time. Naming and discovery—far from being just implementation details—are critical to ensuring authorization systems apply the right policies to the right entities. Well-structured namespaces help support this by providing clarity, uniqueness, and context. Different identity